Lesson 11

AUDIO-VISUAL-AIDS

11.1 Introduction

There are a number of audio-visual aids that could be used in our day-to-day life. This unit will focus on selected audio-visual aids that are normally available and accessible to the users. The term audio-visual aid refers to anything that an extension professional uses to help to convey the message when communicating with his farmers. The spoken words are the main communication tools. However, when the extension professional is speaking to a large village meeting or discussing a problem in a field with a group of farmers, its impact and effectiveness can be greatly enhanced by the use of suitable audio-visual aids. Audio-visual aids are instructional devices through which the messages can be heard and seen, simultaneously.

'The best way to peoples' heart is through their stomach, but the best way to their brain is through their eyes and ears'- **An old proverb**

11.2 Audio-Visual Aids

- ✓ An audio aid is an instructional device in which the message can be heard but not seen.
- ✓ A visual aid is an instructional or communicating device in which the message can be seen but not heard.
- ✓ An audio-visual aid is an instructional device in which message can be heard as well as seen.

Strictly speaking, no teaching method is complete without talk/speech. It must be remembered that audio-visual aids can only supplement the teacher, but cannot supersede & replace/supplant him.

11.3 Dale's Cone of Experience

Dale's Cone of Experience is a model that incorporates several theories related to instructional design and learning processes. During the 1960s, Edgar Dale theorized that learners retain more information by what they do as opposed to what is heard, read or observed. His research led to the development of the Cone of Experience. Today, this learning by doing has become known as experiential learning or action learning. The cone of experience provides a linkage between learning, activity and participant involvement.

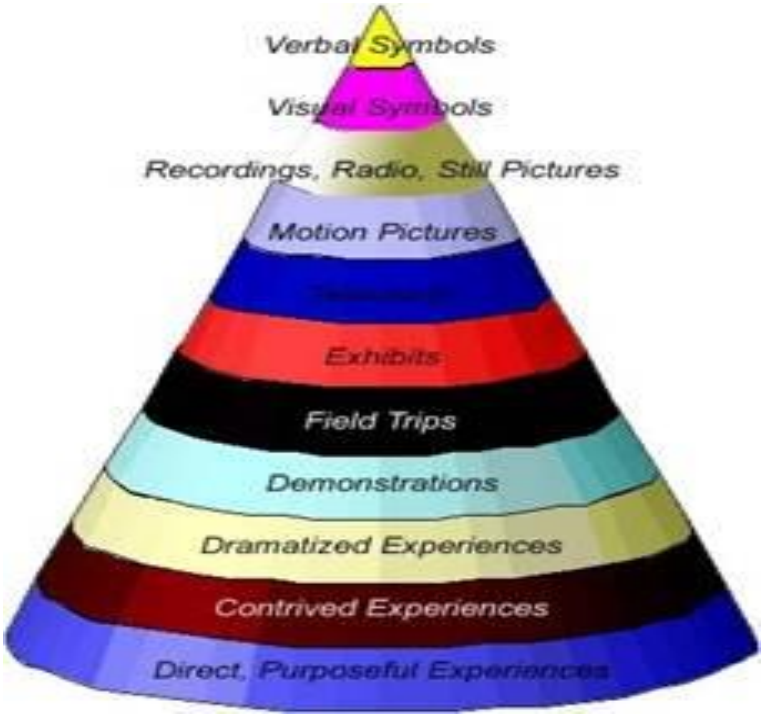


Fig. 12.1 Diagram for Dale's cone of experience

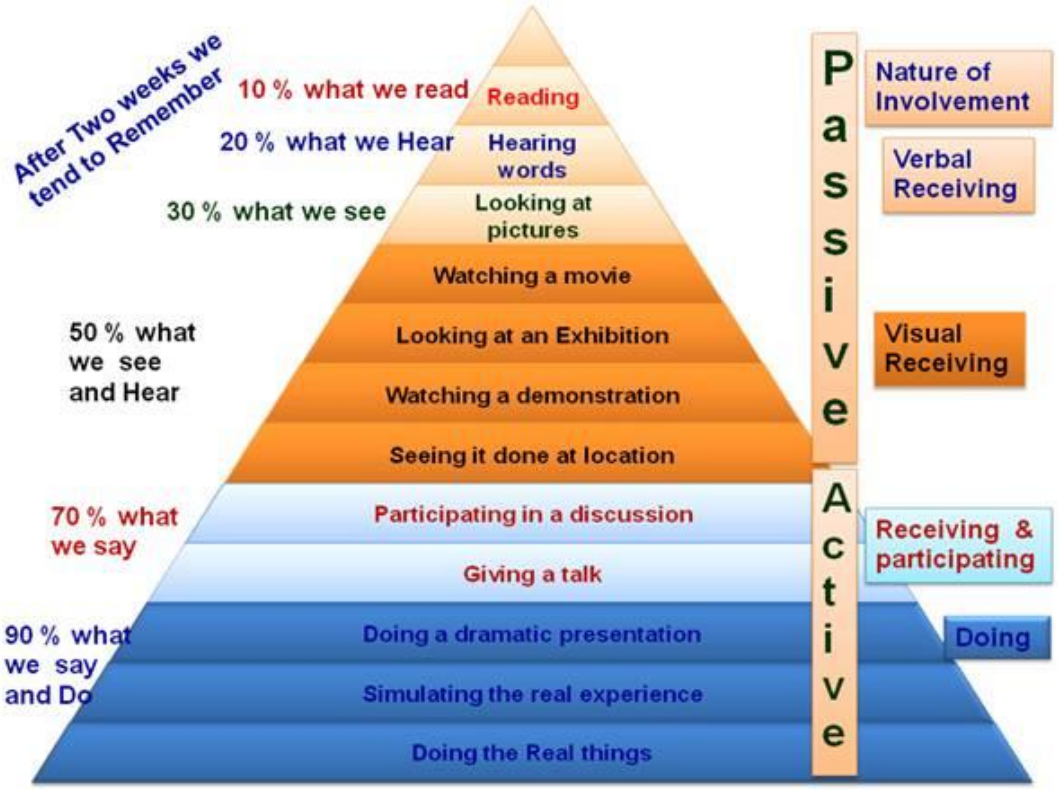


Fig. 12.2 Cone of experience as modified by Sheal

Between the two extreme of reading and doing the real thing are a number of other ways through which people learn. As one moves downwards from the principle of the cone, increased involvement, and learning occur.

11.4 Types of Audio-Visual Aids

i. Verbal symbols

Designations that bear no physical resemblance to the objects or ideas for which they stand. These are used together with every other material on the Cone of Experience.

ii. Visual symbols

Visual symbols involve reproducing real situations, chalkboard and overhead projector (the most widely used media), help students see an idea, event, or process. Examples are flat-makes, chalkboards, sketches, bulletin, boards, flash cards, flannel graphs. Types of such visual symbols could be:

a) Non-projected: (for individual use) e.g. photographs, illustrations.
b) Projected: (for group use) e.g. photographs & illustrations-used in opaque projector, sides, filmstrips.

iii. Recordings, radio

i. *Recordings*: On disc, tape or wire, as it offers wide scope for recording continuously, use the matter, erase it & re-use the conversations recorded.
ii. *Radio*: It is a mass medium or mass contact medium. It facilitates dissemination of information to a large and heterogeneous group of clientele.

iv. Motion pictures or films

These are silent pictures or combination of sight and sound.

V. Exhibitions

Exhibitions are planned display of models, specimens, charts, posters etc. presented for public view for information, advertising or entertainment.

vi. Field-trips/Farm & home visits

These are face-to-face types of individual contact methods employed by the extension professionals to interact with the farmer or members of his family on the farm or at his home for specific purpose connected with extension.

vii. Demonstrations

Methods of teaching designed to show by example the practical application of an established fact or group of related facts. In other words, it is a way of showing people the worth of an improved practice, whose success has already been established.

viii. Dramatized experiences

Participating in a reconstructed experience e.g. dramas, puppet shows.

ix. Contrived experience

A contrived experience may be construed as an edited version of reality, which is differing in nature from the original in size or in complexity or in both e.g. models of animals, mock-ups of machinery, objects, specimens.

x. Direct, purposeful experience

It is the unabridged version of life, itself, with three elements: directness, purposefulness, and responsibility for the outcome e.g. ploughing, cultivation of fodder crop, etc.

The use of audio-visual aids in extension teaching is based on the principle that one must see and try to do, along with hearing, in order to go through all the six steps in the extension teaching learning process.

11.5 Seven R′s of Audio-Visual Aids

- ✓ Right aid
- ✓ Right place
- ✓ Right way
- ✓ Right time
- ✓ Right people
- ✓ Right message
- ✓ Right Extension personnel

11.6 Functions of Audio-Visual Aids

- ✓ Convey meaning clearly
- ✓ Capture attention, arouse and sustain interest
- ✓ Enhance the correctness, clarity and effectiveness of the idea and skills being transferred
- ✓ Help in learning more, faster, and with thoroughness
- ✓ Help in remembering for a longer period
- ✓ Reach more people, irrespective of their level of literacy or language
- ✓ Save the instructor's time
- ✓ Reduce the possibility of misinterpreting concepts
- ✓ Clarify the relationship between material objects and concepts
- ✓ Supplement the spoken word - the combination of audio and visual stimuli is particularly effective since the two most important senses are involved
- ✓ Highlight the main points of the message clearly.

11.7 Limitations of Audio-Visual Aids

- ✓ Learners may sometimes form distorted impressions, unless audio-visual aids are supplemented with required explanations
- ✓ They may tempt the instructor to narrow down his teaching to only a few big ideas, not giving the complete picture of a subject
- ✓ Some instructors acquire the mistaken notion that they have little to do when audio-visual aids are used.

11.8 Importance of Audio-Visual Aids

Audio-Visual aids are supporting materials & they alone cannot generate learning. They should be considered only a tool that helps to do a job in a better way. Visual aids are of different types. The following are the more commonly used ones in Zambia:

i. Posters

A good poster creates awareness & interest among the people. It inspires & takes people towards action. It consists of 3 main parts. The first usually announces the purpose or the approach, the second sets out conditions, & the third recommends action. A poster should be bold enough to attract attention of the people, & should communicate only one idea at a time. It should have simple letters which are clear & forceful. The size of a poster should not be less than 50 X 75 cm.

ii. Flannel graphs

Flannel graphs serve as a good teaching aid when a piece of sandpaper is fixed to the back of a picture, a photograph, a letter, etc. They can be made to adhere easily to a piece of thick flannel cloth, fixed on a board. They are used as an aid for group methods like informal talks or lectures.

iii. Flash cards

Flash cards are a set of small compact cards approximately 30 to 45 cm. in size, and are used to bring home an idea, the rearing of cross breed cows, compost-making and other practices. Pictures on the theme are drawn on these cards in a logical sequence, which are then flashed before the audience. Upon seeing them, the villagers are able to follow a story more easily.

iv. Puppets

Puppets are very popular and especially suitable for village situations. Puppet shows can be effectively organised to gather the rural people. For a puppet show, a short story, brief scenes and quick dialogues are necessary. Such shows can teach a lesson about any specific topic like animal health, literacy, or home-making.

v. Models

Models create a sense of realisation in a person. Models of new farm equipments, compost pits, sanitation devices and animals are mostly prepared for those people who are not in a position to see them in the actual form. They are used to create interest, promote understanding and influence the people to adopt a certain practice.

vi. Bulletin-boards

A bulletin-board can serve the purpose of making announcements, displaying events of short duration & photographs of local activities. The information should be written in simple language.

vii. Photographs

They are a very simple visual aid. Good photographs show some action & catch the feelings & emotions of the people. They are so arranged that they tell a story. They are displayed on a bulletin-board at a common meeting-place where a large number of people can see them. They should be clear & bold in composition with proper captions. *One good picture is perceived as equivalent to 1000 words.*

viii. Cultural programmes

Local cultural programmes, such as folk-songs & dramas, are used as an effective medium of communicating the message of development programmes. Dramatization of a theme or story

creates a lively interest among the audience. Folk-songs & dances related to the subjects of local interest & importance, when acted on the stage, bring them home more forcefully.

For an effective use of extension teaching methods, it is not enough to know these methods and their techniques. What is more important is the appropriate selection of a method or combination of methods for a particular situation. In fact, when a farmer is exposed to a new idea for several times by different methods or a combination of methods, he is likely to accept it more quickly. Farmers learn about new practices through several stages. These stages are known as:

- ✓ ***Awareness stage*** *- when a person comes to know of a new practice but lacks the complete information.*
- ✓ ***Interest stage*** *- when he becomes interested in a new idea & wants to know more about it.*
- ✓ ***Evaluation stage-*** *when he mentally applies the new idea to his present situation & evaluates it.*
- ✓ ***Trial stage-*** *when he applies the new idea or practice on a small scale in order to determine its utility under his own situation.*
- ✓ ***Adoption stage-*** *when he decides to continue the full use of the practice. Thus, it is the cumulative effect on people through exposure to an idea repeatedly that result in action.*

Lesson 12

GROUPS CONCEPTS AND TYPES

12.1 Introduction

From the birth to death an individual associates with groups in some ways or other. Group influences his attitudes, thinking and behavior throughout his life.

A group consists of two or more people who interact with one another and recognize themselves as a distinct social unit. The definition is simple enough, but it has significant implications. Frequent interaction leads people to share values and beliefs. This similarity and the interaction cause them to identify with one another. Identification and attachment, in turn, stimulate more frequent and intense interaction. Each group maintains solidarity with all other groups and other types of social systems. Groups are among the most stable and enduring social units. They are important both to their members and to the society at large. Through encouraging regular and predictable behaviour, groups form the foundation upon which society rests. Thus, a family, a village, a political party, a trade union, etc. are the examples of group.

12.2 Definition

A group is a unit of two or more people in reciprocal interaction or communication with each other. Certain premises, or considerations and characteristics basic to understanding of the concept of groups are as follows:

- ✓ Groups do not form by mere plurality of numbers. Communication and interaction is essential. Two persons can be physically close to one another, in fact seated next to each other and yet not form a group. On the other hand, two other persons, living miles apart, talking to each other over telephone may form a group and of, perhaps, sharing a very intimate kind of relationship. The difference is in terms of interaction and communication.
- ✓ While communication and interaction are essential, it must be reciprocal. One-way communication does not constitute group interaction. People in a group must influence each other on the psychological plane, although the influence may not be equal. Further, this communication need not be face-to-face, but it may be through telephone, letter, radio or other suitable communication media like internet. Physical proximity, then, is not a determining factor in group formation.
- ✓ Groups may be long-lived or of brief duration. They exist only as long as there is reciprocal psychological interaction. Groups cease to exist when active relations between the minds of the two groups and organizations comprise a basic part of virtually every arena of modern life.

Similarly, a **social group** is a collection of people who interact with each other and share similar characteristics and a sense of unity. At the same time, a **social category** is a collection of people who do not interact but who share similar characteristics. For example, women, men, the elderly, and high school pupils and university students all constitute social categories. A social category can become a social group when the members in the category interact with each other and identify themselves as members of the group.

A **social aggregate** is a collection of people who are in the same place, but who do not interact or share specific characteristics.

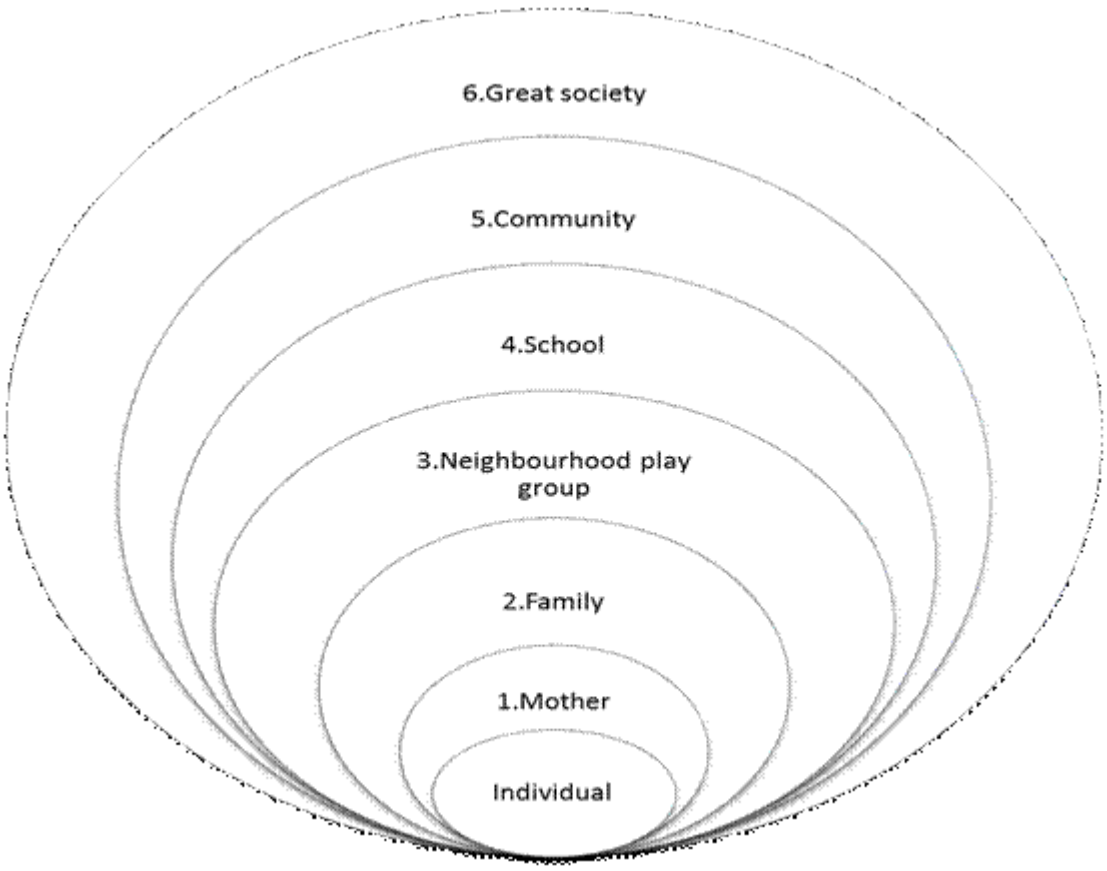


Fig. 13.1 Widening group contact

12.2.1 In-groups, out-groups, and reference groups

In Group: An in-group is a social unit an individual belongs to, interacts with, and shares a sense of we-ness with.

***Out Group*:** An out-group, on the other hand, is a social unit or group of people that an individual neither belongs to nor identifies with. The construction and maintenance of boundaries (physical or symbolic) are the primary ways by which groups establish what it means to be in and, by contrast, what it means to be out.

To some extent, every social group creates boundaries between itself and other groups, but a cohesive *in-group* typically has three characteristics:

- Members use titles, external symbols, and dress to distinguish themselves from the *out-group*.
- Members tend to clash or compete with members of the *out-group*. This competition with the other group can also strengthen the unity within each group.
- Members apply positive stereotypes to their *in-group* and negative stereotypes to the *out-group*.

***Reference Group*:** A reference group is a concept referring to a group to which an individual or another group is compared. Sociologists call any group that individuals use as a standard for evaluating themselves and their own behavior a reference group.

12.2.2. Primary and secondary groups

Groups play a basic role in the development of the social nature and ideals of people. *Primary groups* are those in which individuals intimately interact and cooperate over a long period of time. Examples of primary groups are families, friends, peers, neighbors, classmates, fraternities, and church members. These groups are marked by primary relationships in which communication is informal. Members of primary groups have strong emotional ties. They also relate to one another as whole and unique individuals.

In contrast, *secondary groups* are those in which individuals do not interact much. Members of secondary groups are less personal or emotional than those of primary groups. These groups are marked by secondary relationships in which communication is formal. Members of secondary groups may not know each other or have much face-to-face interaction. They tend to relate to others only in particular roles and for practical reasons. An example of a secondary relationship is that of a producer/seller and consumer.

Primary relationships are most common in small and traditional societies, while secondary relationships are the norm in large and industrial societies. Because secondary relationships often result in loneliness and isolation, some members of society may attempt to create primary relationships through interactions among fellow members. This does not mean, however, that secondary relationships are bad.

Table 12.1 Differences between primary and secondary group

Sl. No.	Primary Groups	Secondary Groups

1	Small size (often less than 20 or 30 persons)	Large size
2	Personal and intimate relationships among members	Impersonal and aloof relationships among members
3	More face-to-face communication	Less face-to-face communication
4	Permanency in nature	Temporary in nature
5	Members are well-acquainted and have a strong sense of loyalty' or "we" feeling; a strong amount of group pressure is present	Members are not well-acquainted and anonymity prevails
6	Informality is most common; the group usually does not have a name, offices or a regular meeting place	Formality prevails. Group often has a name, offices, and a regular meeting place
7	Group decisions are more traditional and non-rational	Group decisions are more rational and the emphasis is on efficiency

In urban societies, secondary relationships are more as compared to the rural society. Primary groups like friends and relatives, directly influence the behaviour of the individual. The impersonal nature of relationship in the secondary group makes up for the absence of the bondage which the primary relations have.

12.2.3 Formal and informal groups

This is a classification of groups according to the mode of organization and functioning of the group.

***Formal groups*:** As the name indicates the formal groups have procedures of functioning. These groups have: a name or title; selected and titled officers; a written purpose and; a regular, common, meeting time and place. The formal groups such as village councils, farmer's societies and school committees have definite rules of operation.

***Informal groups*:** Informal groups like friends, group of a neighborhood do not have any such characteristics. There is no organization or rules. The members have maximum freedom to think and act.

The more people who join a group, the less personal and intimate that group becomes. In other words, as the group increase in size, its members participate and cooperate less, and are more likely to be dissatisfied. A larger group's members may even be inhibited, for example, from publicly helping out victims in an emergency. In this case, people may feel that because so many others are available to help, responsibility to help is shifted to others. Similarly, as the group increases in size, its members are more likely to engage in social loafing, in which people work less because they expect others to take over their tasks.

Lesson 13

LEADERS AND LEADERSHIP

13.1 Introduction

Leader is a person who rules or guides or inspires others.

The objective of the rural development programme is to develop peoples' participation. Therefore, it is essential to encourage and train village leaders who will develop effective working relationships with the rural people. The well-recognized method of working with the rural people is through these leaders. The leaders may be good or bad; progressive or constructive but they guide village thinking and lead them to action. The formal and informal village groups function through these recognized leaders. There are limitations in working alone by the extension professional. If he relies on individual contact, then he cannot greatly multiply his efforts. If he works through village leaders, then the ideas spread quickly among the group and village.

Some of the concepts of leadership are as follows:

- ✓ Leadership is the process of directing the behavior of others towards the accomplishment of some common objectives.
- ✓ Leadership is influencing people to get things done to a standard and quality above their norm and doing it willingly.
- ✓ Leadership is a process by which a person influences others to accomplish an objective and directs the organization in a way that makes it more cohesive and coherent.

Leaders carry out this process by applying their leadership attributes, such as beliefs, values, ethics, character, knowledge, and skills. Although your position as a manager, supervisor, lead, etc. gives you the authority to accomplish certain tasks and objectives in the organization, this power does not make you a leader, it simply makes you the boss. Leadership differs in that it makes the followers want to achieve high goals, rather than simply bossing people around.

Good leaders are made not born. If you have the desire and will power, you can become an effective leader. Good leaders develop through a never-ending process of self-study, education, training, and experience. This guide will help you through that process.

To inspire our workers into higher levels of teamwork, there are certain things which we must be, know, and, do. These do not come naturally, but are acquired through continual work and study. Good leaders are continually working and studying to improve their leadership skills; they are NOT resting on their laurels.

Bass' theory of leadership states that there are three basic ways to explain how people become leaders. The first two explain the leadership development for a small number of people. These theories are:

- ✓ Some personality traits may lead people naturally into leadership roles. This is the *Trait Theory*.
- ✓ A crisis or important event may cause a person to rise to the occasion, which brings out extraordinary leadership qualities in an ordinary person. This is the *Great Events Theory*.
- ✓ People can choose to become leaders. People can learn leadership skills. This is the *Transformational Leadership Theory*. It is the most widely accepted theory today and the premise on which this guide is based.

13.2 Qualities of a Good Leader

Here are some of the qualities which can make an individual a good leader:

- ✓ A leader should be commendable and exemplary. A good leader should be trustworthy so that people can follow him. He should live his life with honesty and integrity. He should live a life such that nobody can question his character.
- ✓ A good leader is always enthusiastic about the cause of the people. He must have the capability to see what is good or bad for the people in the long run. He approaches a problem in a holistic manner and never believes himself different from his people and subject.
- ✓ A leader believes in discipline. He follows an orderly manner and routine but still he is tolerant. He takes decision keeping emotions and personal matters aside.
- ✓ A leader has excellent logical and analytical skills. He looks each and every aspect of the situation before arriving to any decision and never loses his temper in difficult situations. He should think positively in each and every situation.
- ✓ A leader should always focus towards his goals, what he has envisioned for and promised to his people. He should take each and every decision keeping in mind the people and his subject.
- ✓ A great leader is proactive and committed to excellence. He always maintains high standard and acts as an idol for his followers. His personal and public life both are remarkable and stain-free.

- ✓ A leader inspires his team to achieve target and lead them to success. He brings best out of them in the time of crisis also.

- ✓ A good leader is the one who can give people voice and direction.

✓ A leader should be tolerant of uncertainty and should always remain tranquil, composed and persistent to his goals.

✓ A good leader always keeps a cool head in times of crises and finds solutions to get everybody out of any difficult situation.

13.3 Types of Leader or Leadership Style

Leadership style is the manner and approach of providing direction, implementing plans, and motivating people. This early study has been very influential and established three major leadership styles. The three major styles of leadership are,

- ✓ Authoritarian or autocratic
- ✓ Participative or democratic
- ✓ Delegative or Free Reign

Although good leaders use all **three styles**, with one of them normally dominant, bad leaders tend to stick with one style.

i. Authoritarian (Autocratic)

This style is used when leaders tell their employees what they want done and how they want it accomplished, without getting the advice of their followers. Some of the appropriate conditions to use it are when you have all the information to solve the problem, you are short on time, and your employees are well motivated.

Some people tend to think of this style as a vehicle for yelling, using demeaning language, and leading by threats and abusing their power. This is not the authoritarian style, rather it is an abusive, unprofessional style called **bossing people around**. It has no place in a leader's repertoire.

The authoritarian style should normally only be used on rare occasions. If you have the time and want to gain more commitment and motivation from your employees, then you should use the participative style.

ii. Participative (Democratic)

This style involves the leader including one or more employees in the decision making process (determining what to do and how to do it). However, the leader maintains the final decision

making authority. Using this style is not a sign of weakness; rather it is a sign of strength that your employees will respect.

This is normally used when you have part of the information, and your employees have other parts. Note that a leader is not expected to know everything this is why you employ *knowledgeable* and *skillful* employees. Using this style is of mutual benefit it allows them to become part of the team and allows you to make better decisions.

iii. Delegative or laissez faire (free reign)

In this style, the leader allows the employees to make the decisions. However, the leader is still responsible for the decisions that are made. This is used when employees are able to analyze the situation and determine what needs to be done and how to do it. You cannot do everything! You must set priorities and delegate certain tasks.

This is not a style to use so that you can blame others when things go wrong, rather this is a style to be used when you fully trust and confidence in the people below you. Do not be afraid to use it, however, use it **wisely!**